

1941–50

MAY 19, 1941

Ho Chi Minh and his colleagues found the Viet Minh movement to fight against the French colonialists and the Japanese occupation of Vietnam.

MARCH 9, 1945

Japanese troops take over Indochina from the French, declaring Vietnam, Cambodia, and Laos independent. Emperor Bao Dai officially rules Vietnam.



French troops land in Indochina, 1945

SEPTEMBER 2, 1945

Ho Chi Minh declares an independent North Vietnam.

DECEMBER 19, 1946

After French warships shell Viet Minh forces in Haiphong (November 23), the Viet Minh attack Hanoi, starting the First Indochina War.

FEBRUARY 1950

Armed by Communist China, the Viet Minh take the offensive, attacking French outposts on Vietnam's northern border.